Dear Halden Pay Hiring Team,

I am applying for the Senior Data Engineer – Data Platform position. In my current role at Lukovac Freight Hub, I own the design, ingestion, orchestration and day-to-day operation of a production data platform built with Airflow, Snowflake, dbt and Kafka. I would bring that hands-on experience designing, building and operating production data platforms and cloud data warehouses at scale to a team building shared, reusable data capabilities for analysts, data scientists and product teams.

Recent work includes building a shipment-event pipeline processing around 30 million events per day, with end-to-end latency under two minutes at p95, and adding dead-letter and replay tooling to reprocess failed events without data loss. I also migrated approximately 300 stored procedures into tested, documented dbt models, introducing incremental processing and clearer lineage while reducing the nightly warehouse build from 5 hours 10 minutes to 1 hour 35 minutes. This work strengthened SQL-based data modelling, introduced incremental models, and gave analysts clearer lineage. In 2024, I reduced monthly Snowflake spend from approximately $38,000 to $24,000 through warehouse sizing, auto-suspend and removal of unused tables.

My earlier experience at Kovalent Pay is especially relevant to Halden Pay's payments work. I built PySpark batch jobs on AWS EMR and worked with AWS-based data services including S3, Glue Data Catalog and Redshift for a transaction reconciliation engine matching bank settlement files against internal ledgers, reducing manual finance-team reconciliation from around three days to four hours per month-end. I also worked on data quality with Great Expectations, giving me practical experience improving trust in production data. I have also contributed two merged pull requests to an Airflow provider package, fixing a pagination bug and adding tests. Alongside mentoring engineers and running data-platform office hours, these experiences reflect the ownership, collaboration and practical focus on reducing complexity that I would bring to the role.

I hold an MSc in Computer Science from Northgate Technical University, where my thesis was about incremental materialized views. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my experience building and operating production data platforms, improving data quality, and simplifying data workflows could contribute to Halden Pay's Data Platform team.

Kind regards,

Lena Varga-Holm